of ideology as a determinant of foreign policy because, in its true sense, it is primarily used as a garb to hide the real intentions of the actors in international relations.

9. Public Opinion: In a democratic state it is impossible for the government to ignore the importance of public opinion in both domestic and foreign policies. This is true today more than ever before because of the revolution in information technology, mass media, telecommunications, internet and the like. People are now far more informed than was the case earlier. As such public opinion dose set the limit for the domestic as well as the foreign policies. In case of foreign policy, public opinion sets: (i) broad limits of constraint regarding the choice of policies—the 'mood' of the public; (ii) constraints in the policy execution. As in the case of the Vietnam War, the then American government had to succumb to the public opinion and was compelled to withdraw. In India, after the 1962 jolt given by China and the defeat of the Indian army, there was severe dent in Krishna Menon's image as a Defence Minister, and he had to face hostile public opinion which resulted first in his demotion to the Position of Minister of Defence Production ; ultimately he had to resign even though he had great personal equations with Prime Minister Nehru.

External Determinants

International Regimes and Organization: The foreign policies of the states have to operate taking into consideration the external environment also. The first and the most important factor that constrains or influences the making of the foreign policies is the presence of international laws, international treaties, pacts, trading blocs and various international and regional organizations. Several bilateral and multilateral treaties and agreements have to be taken into consideration when foreign policy choices are set. Activities of international organizations like the United Nations and its agencies, the IMF, World Bank, WTO and regional organizations like ASEAN, SAARC, NAFTA, APEC and military pacts like NATO have an important bearing on the foreign policies of every state.

World Public Opinion: Domestic public opinion is an important